These issues share a common characteristic. None is abstractly "constitutional"; all are concretely political. So are the causes of concern behind them. So will be the results. Politically these issues are alive as products of Vietnam, once "Johnson's war," now Nixon's. Their resolution probably is bound up with its outcome. The connection is a matter partly of specifics, from Cambodian invasions to Laotian incursions to whatever next fuels Congressional opposition. More important for the longer run is memory, not in terms befitting a historian but in the looser terms of popular impression.

Thirty years ago, what constrained Franklin Roosevelt was not alone, or even mainly, words in statutes, but rather the forbidding strength of isolationist convictions moving millions of his fellow citizens. What fueled their convictions? A deeply held impression that American involvement in the First World War had been a needless waste, a plot for profit.

Twenty years ago, or ten, or even five, the freedom, relatively speaking, felt and asserted by successive Presidents reflected not alone Congressional but also widespread press and public sentiment. What fueled this permissiveness? Above all "Munich" as remembered after victory in World War II.

Ten years hence we think the "balance" between President and Congress will be no less affected by the net impression of our longest war.